EN EL CASTILLO DE LOS FANTASMAS 2



MSX

V9990

USER MANUAL

The MSX game on the V9990

MAD MIX 2

for the Yamaha V9990

MSX V9990

An original game by **Topo Soft**, 1990.
V9990 port by **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.



This is an unofficial port made for study, preservation, and homage.

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1. What you need

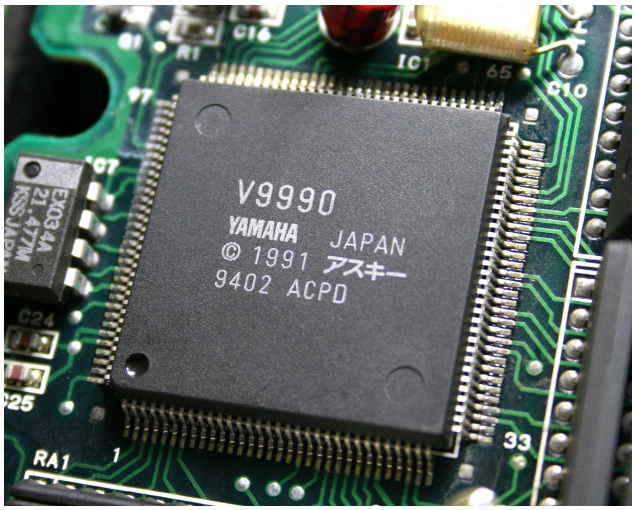


Figure 1: The Yamaha V9990 video processor, the chip this version of the game draws with.

Item	Requirement
Computer	**Any MSX1** with two cartridge slots, one for the game and one for the V9990.
Memory	**64 KB of RAM** in the main memory (all four pages).
Video	A mandatory **V9990 cartridge** for all screens after the initial check, including credits, menu and gameplay.
Sound	MSX PSG for music and effects.
Game	The **Mad Mix 2 V9990 cartridge**: a 1 MiB ASCII16 MegaROM (the file `madmix2-v99990.rom`, written to a flash cartridge or equivalent).
Monitor	Access to both MSX and V9990 video outputs: two displays or a monitor with input selection.
Controls	Cursor keys; Space or M to jump. Joystick in either port, with either button.

No tape, no disk, no password. The whole game is in the cartridge.

2. Setting up

1. **Switch the MSX off.** Never insert or remove a cartridge with the power on.
2. Insert the **V9990 cartridge** in one of the cartridge slots.
3. Insert the game cartridge in the other slot. For MegaFlashROM SD SCC+, copy the ROM to the SD as `MADMIX2.ROM` and flash with `OPFXSD MADMIX2.ROM /A16`. `/U` is optional: without it, the game uses a subslot; with it, it uses the primary slot. `/A16` forces ASCII16 if automatic detection fails.
4. Connect both video outputs. Begin with the MSX output to check detection, then switch to V9990 for the rest of the game.
5. Connect a joystick to port 1 or 2 if you want to use one.
6. Switch the MSX on. Its output shows `V9990 found!`. If it says `V9990 NOT found!`, switch off and check the V9990 cartridge.

If you cannot see the picture, check the selected input against section 3. Also check the cartridges and RAM. The supplied launcher switches video outputs automatically in the emulator.

3. From power-on to the game



Figure 2: Left: the cover. Right: the title screen.

1. **V9990 check.** The MSX output shows Topo Soft 1990, V9990 DiHalt Studio 2026 and the V9990 detection result. These messages remain there while you play on the V9990 output.
2. **DiHalt Studio.** Switch to the V9990 output. The logo stays for about nine seconds until its music finishes, then advances automatically.
3. **Opening illustration.** Press and release Control, Space, Enter, M or fire to continue.
4. **Topo Soft.** The animation advances automatically.
5. **Title.** The colour logo appears. Press and release any opening-screen input to advance.
6. **Credits and difficulty.** These stay on V9990. Choose `STANDARD / HARD` with cursor keys or the joystick, then confirm with fire. An arrow and green lettering show the selection; the default is `STANDARD`.
7. **Play.** Press fire when prompted, including the stage introduction and `READY`.

After `GAME OVER`, you can start another game from the same difficulty menu, with STANDARD selected again.

4. Controls

Action	Keyboard	Joystick
Up / down	Cursor keys	Stick
Left / right	Cursor keys	Stick
Jump / fire	**SPACE** or **M**	Button A or B
Pause	**H**	Keyboard
Music on / off	**V**	Keyboard

Keyboard and either joystick port are available together. At the menu, Space, M or either button confirms the difficulty. Control and Enter also advance past the opening illustration and title, although neither screen shows a prompt.

Release fire and press it again for another jump. To leave pause, release the keys and press a gameplay key. **V** switches music on or off.

5. The story

Mad Mix has restored peace to Cocovillage, but his cousin Ope faces a new nightmare in Cococastle. A surviving coco has taken refuge in the castle and joined its sinister inhabitants. Mad must come to the rescue once more.

6. How to play

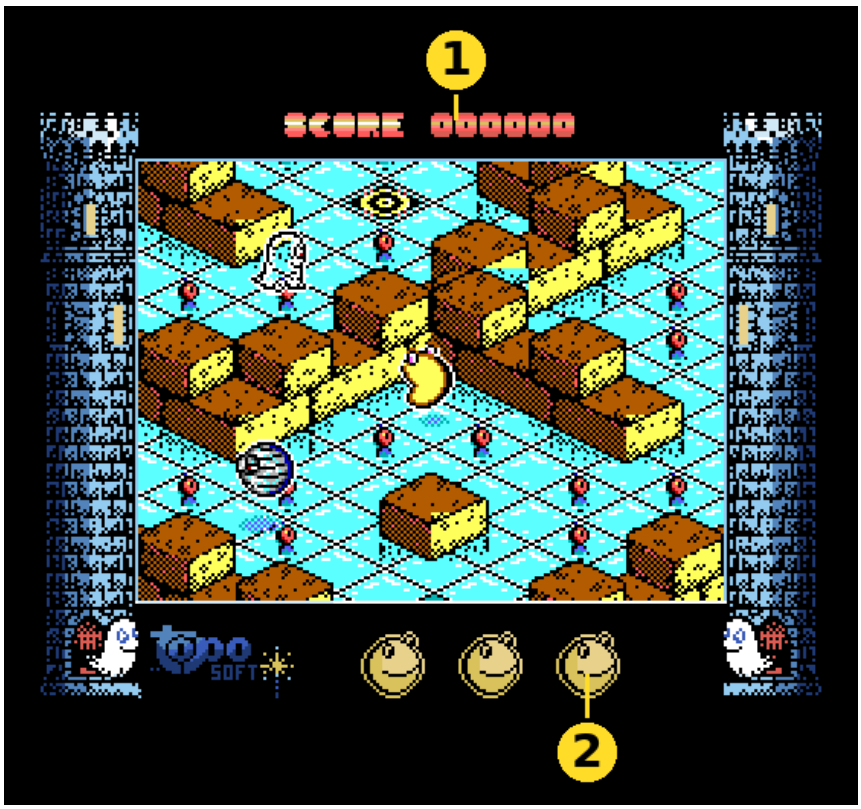
Explore the corridors and collect cocos to progress through the castle. Avoid enemies and traps; use your jump to overcome obstacles.

There are nine stages. Completing the ninth returns you to the first. Each stage is announced before play begins. If you lose a life, you return to the stage's starting position; cocos already collected remain collected.

Mad stays centred while the scenery scrolls around him; jumping retains its vertical movement. Movement and animation keep a regular cadence; music retains its normal tempo.

STANDARD keeps regular movement speed. **HARD** doubles base movement for Mad and other actors. Mad's speed boost has the same maximum in both modes.

7. The screen



No.	Element	Meaning
1	SCORE	Points accumulated during the current game.
2	Yellow faces	Reserve lives; the life currently in use is not shown.

8. Points, lives and tips

You start with one active life and three reserves. An empty life display still leaves you with the life in play. Extra lives can raise your reserves to four.

A normal coco adds one point, except when it triggers a collection bonus. Other pickups and effects can award different amounts. `SCORE` resets when you begin a new game.

- Hold **F1** while dismissing the opening illustration with Space or fire to avoid contact damage from ghosts, Dracula and Franky. Balls and traps remain dangerous.
- Press and release fire for each jump; holding it does not chain jumps.
- Push corks into enemy exits to block them temporarily. Catch the fleeing accelerator again to gain its speed boost.
- Push balls toward monsters and keep clear of their path once they roll.
- Use **H** when you need a break. **V** silences the music.

9. Credits and rights

- **Mad Mix 2** is a game by **Topo Soft**, 1990. The game, its graphics, music and name belong to their rights holders. This is an unofficial port made for study, preservation and homage; it is not affiliated with them.
- **V9990 version** (display engine, tools, colour artwork integration and cartridge adaptation): **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.
- MSX is a trademark of MSX Licensing Corporation. The MSX logo is shown only to say which computers the game runs on (file `MSX-Logo.svg`, Wikimedia Commons).
- V9990 chip photo: Yaca2671, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 3.0; unmodified.
- DiHalt Studio opening logo and fanfare: DiHalt Studio presentation assets.
- Opening illustration: artwork supplied for this edition. Title logo, characters and game music: original game material.
- Source code available on GitLab. **Please improve the game if you feel so!**

Appendix. Cartridge label

A label for the cartridge, ready to print. At 100 % it is about 16 cm wide; scale it in your printing program to fit the label area of your cartridge (the artwork has a 3:2 proportion).

